



The efficient methods of persuasion and their employment in the Algerian touristic literature

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Abstract ;

This study sheds light on the mechanisms used in the process of persuasion, and gives an image about the status-quo of the Algerian touristic literature regarding its influence that is built on relations that link the elements of the creative process, namely the author, the text, and the recipient. We relied on some concepts and theories to read the structure of the text and provide some verbal and moral methods that help transfer the notion of discourse to complete the process of persuasion

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1. Introduction

Thinkers and scholars have so long focused on the question of persuasion in their writings and discourses for its role in the human life. For instance, Aristotle tackled the question based on ethics, emotions, and logic. However, there are different definitions and concepts to persuasion, according to the different perspectives. In a related context, the touristic literature imposed itself on the international scene as a new bridge between literature and tourism. Based on what was said, we shall study the question of the efficient persuasion mechanisms and how they are used in the Algerian touristic literature. In so doing, some questions arise, such as:

- What is the definition of persuasion?
- What is the concept of touristic literature?
- What are the main procedures in the process of persuasion?
- To what extent did the Algerian touristic literature take advantage of it in the light of the modern poem that opens to various structures?

We chose this focal point for the importance of persuasion and this literature. In this regard, we answered the questions through different steps.

First, we defined the touristic literature and persuasion. Then, we discussed the aim behind literature and the relation between the creative author and the recipient. After that, we focused on the factors of the text influence, the efficient literary style, the mechanism of influence used in the Algerian touristic literature, and ended with a conclusion that shows the findings.

We used the analytical descriptive method because it suits the nature of the topic, and the thematic and stylistic methods to analyze some literary texts. For a deeper understanding, we reviewed some literature, such as the book “al Shiir wa al Shoaara” of Ibn Qutaibah, and the article “al Nas wa al Qari Inda Aizer” of Sudani Abd al Haq. It is worth mentioning that we faced some difficulties, mainly that the studies on the touristic literature are not available.

2. The concept of the touristic literature:

This expression is unprecedented in the Arab literature unlike the Western, where we find its traces in the novels, poetry, applied arts like cinema and TV, and paintings. Djamel Badran defines it as wandering in realms and horizons far from the seen and heard, to a point closer to the famous travel literature, as it brings closer the far and depicts far

sceneries, developed or uncivilized people, foreign or similar lifestyles, and species who lived or still live on Earth and in seas. However, he sees that the touristic literature sounds to us something different than what we know about the travel literature.

Nevertheless, the touristic literature addresses the human senses, describes what is seen, heard, and tasted, is a direct independent description, and may overlap with the narrative or descriptive structures. It shows eloquence in formulating the expression targeting an embellished description addressed to the travel desires or the pleasure seekers. Badran sees that defining and making pleasure are the main pillars of the touristic literature, emphasizing that this literature seeks nothing but covering the touristic services with an exciting formulation that incarnates the echoes of the past in a contemporary striking voice admired by the foreigners and their senses; this maybe a way towards the universality of this literature¹.

3. Definition of persuasion:

The term has different uses in different fields for its importance in the human life and role in communication and interaction. Many theorizers tackled

the methods, branches, and nature of persuasion, including Tarek al Suwaiden who sees that persuasion is urging the others to understand your point of view, and to support you in conveying information to them and gaining their trust. He adds that we may report facts and results using material proofs and evidences without making them feel any superiority².

The main element in the process is gaining trust, which comes after an organized work based on providing information and views supported by logical confirmations and strong proofs. In the subconsciousness, the person with the ability to persuade is given a high position and is well-estimated, as he has big abilities that help influence the others and gain their trust.

4. The aim of literature:

There are different definitions to literature based on the different angles the thinkers look from. In this context, Mohamed Mandour defines literature as an artistic formulation of a human experience, or a criticism of life. He adds that we can insinuate to some goals when we identify a literary creed, such as art for art, which is the creed that takes literature to create aesthetic values; romanticism that takes literature

¹ Djamel Badran, the touristic literature, knowledge house, Cairo, 1998, pp. 59-60.

² Tarek Mohamed al Suwaidan & Faycel Mohamed Bacher Ahbel, manufacturing the leader, Kuwait, Vol. 04, 2006, p. 149.

to express the self; and realism that shows the evil of the human life³. Part of thinkers consider literature as an escape that uses aestheticism to enjoy, with no interest in the values and no attempt to change people and depict their preoccupations. On the other hand, others see that literature must express people needs and depict their life details and the social negative phenomena. In general, we can say that literature is a world that expresses the human and depicts his aspirations and pains through special language.

As for the difference between the scientific and literary languages, the target notion is the difference, as the scientific addresses the mind and shows facts far from emotionality to persuade, while the other addresses the emotions through the sensual experiences and values it depicts to create amusement and persuasion through taste. In addition, the scientific language is exact with no generalization and insinuations, contrary to the literary that uses refined terms, allusion, excitement, inclusion, metaphor, and images. Additionally, the experiment in the scientific language is a tool to establish rules and laws, as supported by Sayed Qutub who believes that the experiment after formulating the

rule has no value, save its historical nature that shows how the world had developed, unlike in literature, where the experience is the target per se⁴.

Explicitly, the role of the recipient emotionality in the literary language manifests through the formal structure or the strength of meaning. Sometimes, the author plays a vital role in influencing the recipient thanks to the stunning writing full of excitement and repetition of words and expressions. Moreover, raising and lowering the tone attracts and influences the recipient. Arabic involves imagination that excites and amuses the recipient and fosters the meaning. We find much difference regarding the question of the literature aims, as some see that literature is, like the other arts, amusement that has no more place in the science and production life of nowadays. On the other side, some see it is necessary in life, as it satisfies urgent needs that are as important as the material ones. Some others see that literature must contribute to organizing the general production, fostering justice, and fair wealth distribution⁵.

Thus, some see literature as marginal in life, claiming it is inefficient unlike food, water, etc, while others see

³ Mohamed Mandour, literature and its methods, Egypt renaissance for printing, publication, and distribution, Egypt, 2006, p. 183.

⁴ Suzane Abd al Wahed Abd al Jabbar, the difference between the literary and scientific languages, board of

the Faculty of Applied Sciences, University of Anbar, Iraq, <https://www.uoanbar.edu.iq/> 2022-08-19

⁵ Mohamed Mandour, op. cit, pp. 183-184.

it is a life support that cannot be left because man needs a world of noble feelings, inspirational words, exciting imagination, and aesthetic expressions coming from the heart to the heart. Furthermore, man needs a talented person who expresses his hopes and pains using a well-woven plot and purposeful goals.

5. The relation between the creative author and the recipient:

The creative process is based on the author, the text, and the recipient. In order to evaluate any poet, we must base the evaluation on the vision level, which relies on special characteristics, mainly his mastery of providing a new image of the world he lives in and of the world we live in; the expression structure that is open to his ability to give this image an new expressive structure; and his ability to start from the language of the community to found the speech that influences it.

To better transfer the literary message, the author must consider the culture and specificity of the recipient. In this regard, we cannot write an abstract poem to a recipient with a limited educational level because the recipient is a cornerstone in the creative process and the positive communication

needs an exercised author who knows how to employ the textual signs and keys in his work. In addition, the recipient must go up to the text level through striking with the textual relations and digging in all the contextual and pattern levels. Despite the different critical methods from context to pattern to the reader theory, we cannot isolate any condition of the creative process because they overlap, and the creative author knits an influential text that attracts the reader and triggers his criticism to issue a new bright text⁶.

6. The factors of the text influence:

The text is one of the main elements in literature, as it contributes to rapprochement or repel between the author and the recipient. In addition, it is the mirror that reflects the author's identity, thoughts, and vision towards the world. Many definitions were attributed to the text from different schools and orientations, mainly that of Halliday & Rokia Hassan, who believe it is a spoken or written paragraph regardless its length, and is the unit of the used language with no specific length. They add that it is related to the method the whole is linked to the sentence, and that the best vision to the text is considering it a one semantic unit,

⁶ See: Mohamed Abd al Hadi, the literary text between the creative author and the recipient, al Makhbar journal, Faculty of Letters and Human and Social

Sciences, University of Mohamed Khider in Biskra, 2009, issue 01, pp. 228-229.

which cannot be considered as a form because it has a meaning linked to the cognition (comprehension), not the size⁷.

The literary critics classified the literary texts based on formal, objective, purposive, and historical criteria that regard the nature of the text. The historical criterion links the old and modern texts to produce comparisons while the formal considers the linguistic structure⁸. In addition, the objective covers the content of the text to find out whether it is political, religious, or other, while the purposive investigates the purpose behind the text. Regarding the general vision, the classification of the literary texts relies on the big semantic structure. We shall speak about some factors that must be found in the text to allow for the optimal persuasion of the recipient:

6.1 Cohesion and Coherence:

The terms are interrelated and are two faces of one coin. The 1st is about linking the items of the surface text (the words) while the 2nd is about linking its perceptions and concepts. The two factors complement each other in shaping the text and its dynamics, and

must be found in each text⁹ to serve the meaning and form.

6.2 The situationality:

At this level, writing knits the perceptions and ideas with the event. This criterion includes the factors that link the text to a given situation¹⁰. The text is a work that can control and change the situation. This criterion strongly resembles the Arab patrimonial rhetorical quote “li Kolli Maqamin Maqal”, literally, “other times, other manners”. In this context, the text must correspond to the current situation.

6.3 The informativity:

It is the process of integrating specific information in a text. It differs according to the type of the text. Informativity has a high level when we find many alternatives¹¹. The difference at the informativity level is clearly seen between the literary texts and the others, because the literary texts generally have less information, and the provision of information is not limited to a specific number of words or phrases, as one information may be given in one word or a whole poetic line. However, the most important is informing the

⁷ Michael Halliday & Rokia Hassan, cohesion in English, Longman, London, 1976, pp. 1-2

⁸ See: Naaman Bouguerra, discourse, theory, and procedure, King Saud University house for publication, 2014, p. 24.

⁹ John Liners, language, meaning, and context, trans. Abbas Sadek Waheb, general cultural issues house, Arab horizons, Iraq, Vol. 01, 1987, p. 221.

¹⁰ Robert De Beaugrand, the text, the discourse, and the procedure, trans. Tammam Hassan, books world, Cairo, Vol. 01, 1998, p. 104.

¹¹ Ibid., p. 105.

recipient regardless the method and nature of the text, pushing the recipient towards the content of the text to get persuaded.

6.4 The efficient literary style:

The “literary style” refers to the way the author feels, thinks, and expresses his feelings and ideas¹². Each author has his own method of writing based on his inclinations and trends. For instance, the style of Nizar Qabbani is successful thanks to the easy words he uses, which are, at the same time, tightly connected to provide allusive expressions that trigger imagination and influence the recipient. In addition, Wolf Gang focuses on the term “reader” and shows how he is related to the realm of the text and how he exercises his orientations that strongly affect the meaning of the text. Besides, with his implicit definition, Aizer emphasizes the textual state, i.e., the text as it is, and the production of meaning through reading¹³.

The literary writing is not a mere building and selection of words; rather, it is influence and contemplation, followed by expression that voices out the subjective and social experiences.

Each writer has his own traditions, which pave the way towards success or failure. For example, the author that is influenced by the beauty of a place and feels an inner attraction towards it finds himself in a superior world that takes him closer to weaving a unique masterpiece, mainly if accompanied by imagination, refined language, and style that pushes the recipient to accept the idea and enjoy the literary work. The inner influence has its effect on the creation of an influential literary work because, at this emotional moment, the author fuses and attempts to explode his language to satisfy the desires of the recipient.

Moreover, the author must keep away from excessive garments, metaphors, and images in his texts. On the other hand, Ibn Qutaibah tackles the situation of the talented poet who masters the use of the rhymes and can produce a coherent text and show the requirements of the literary writing¹⁴. The essence towards influence is creating a literary text in a moment of truth accompanied by the author’s feelings, spontaneousness, and experience to push the recipient to interact with his senses, spirit, and depths, and achieve amusement and

¹² Ismail Mostefa al Sifi, Mohamed Ben Abdellah, & Mohamed Zaki al Athmawi, the literary criticism and the rhetoric, Ministry of Education, Kuwait, Vol. 01, 1970, p. 09.

¹³ See: Sudani Abd al Haq, the text and the reader for Aizer, journal of concepts of the philosophical and

deep human studies, University of Djelfa, 2020, issue 07, p. 240.

¹⁴ Ibn Qutaibah, poetry and poets, investigated by Ahmed Mohamed Chaker, al Hadith house, Cairo, 2007, p. 91.

persuasion. For example, the salutation words, such as hello and welcome, have special effect on the recipient because they directly address his heart. In addition, the author may use indirect metaphors to attract the readers.

In addition, the other efficient mechanism is using selfness (derived from the self), through which the writer leaves himself and speaks on behalf of a place or a value. In this context, he may impersonate a place and speak about its history and beauty to influence and convince the reader.

7. The mechanisms of influence in the Algerian touristic literature:

Language is a cornerstone in the literary creativity, as it cannot be considered a mere communication or expression, because it is a method of influence, mainly if the author has a strong talent that empowers him to use language excellently through choosing the best terms and taming language; taming language is explained by al Mibrad as targeting the doer to satisfy the need¹⁵. This allows the author to influence the recipient, mainly in the touristic literature that relies on persuasion to visit the place, attend a cultural event, discovering a given society known for its noble values, etc.

Here, language is the factor that gathers the mechanisms of influence used in the touristic literature. These mechanisms include the confirmation that relies on repetition of letters, words, or sentences to influence the recipient and show impression and admiration. In addition, it draws the attention of the recipient and excitement to facilitate persuasion.

In his poem “Man Yashtari al Khulda fa Inna Allaha Baiuhu”, the Algerian poet, Moufdi Zakaria, celebrates the beauty of Constantia, ex Cirta, saying:

Wa Kullu Shaiin bi Cirta al
Yawma Mughtabitun Wa Kullu
Shaiin bi Cirta al Yawma Mahsudun¹⁶

Literally:

Everything in Cirta today is
happy everything in Cirta today is
envied

Zakaria used this repetition to insist on the beauty of Cirta and attract and influence the recipient. For this poet, Constantine is the beauty, tranquility, joy, and welfare.

In addition, in his poem “Wasfu Fawwara”, Mohamed al Aid al Khalifa

¹⁵ Abu al Abbas Mohamed al Mibrad, the book of the brief, investigated by Mohamed Abd al Khaleq Adima, Vol. 03, University of al Azher, Cairo, 1994, p. 76.

¹⁶ Moufdi Zakariya, the sacred blaze, the national institution for printed arts, Reghaia, Algeria, 2007, p. 226.

describes a mesmerizing fountain in a public garden in Batna, saying:

Ya Habbadha Ainun Tafuru
Huffat bi Haffatiha Zuhuru

Batat bi Batna Tufidu
ala Sarairina Sururu

Fi Rawdatin Ghann'in Kad
Ghannat bi Sahatiha Tuyuru¹⁷

Literally:

What a stunning fountain
surrounded by roses

It is in Batna adding to our
souls joy

In a mesmerizing garden where
birds are chirping

The use of repetition in the Arabic version is seen in the word "Kad", which serves as a confirmation connector to emphasize the action of chirping, beauty, and joy because the space is open and full of beautiful scenes, mainly the flowing water from the fountain. This psychological influence is key in the touristic literature, mainly if the author masters the depiction of the event and its effect. Undoubtedly, visiting a touristic site or living within a given society creates a special reaction if well aesthetically

depicted for the recipient, pushing him to spiritually experience the events and to think about physically doing it.

In addition, in Salim Batka's novel "Judhur wa Ajniha", the protagonist Fabian who is sent by the French authorities to control the inhabitants of the Saharan village gets influenced by the villagers whose kindness pushes him to team up with them against the French. In this regard, fascinated by the beauty of the Algerian Sahara, Fabian says "I shall remain, for the rest of my life, in love with these horizons ..."¹⁸. In this quote, the author depicted the big influence on Fabian, and his loyalty and love to the fascinating Sahara. Most of the Algerian poets who wrote poems with touristic aims focused on the beauty of the open spaces, mainly the charming Algerian nature, with its several features.

8. Conclusion:

Upon our study, we find out the big role of persuasion in the touristic literature, as it pushes the recipient to try the experience after getting persuaded by the literary texts that can be touristic guides par excellence. In this regard, the touristic literature cannot stand without persuasion, which relies on the refined language, style, and method of

¹⁷ Mohamed al Aid al Khalifa, the collection of Mohamed al Aid al Khalifa, al Houdda house, Ain Mlila, Algeria, 2010, p. 51.

¹⁸ Salim Batka, the novel of Judhur wa Ajniha, Ali Ben Zayd house for publication and distribution, Biskra, Algeria, Vol. 01, 2014.

introducing the touristic literary work. Noticeably, the Algerian touristic literature is marked by the scholars focus on the natural beauty of the country and the use of persuasion and repetition in very aesthetic sentences. All the Algerian authors who write about tourism should enrich this literature with efficient persuasion mechanisms to introduce the Algerian touristic sites to a wider audience. Besides, shedding light on the touristic literary texts by the media outlets and the focus on the author, the touristic literary text, and the literary activity shall help convey the touristic literary message more efficiently.

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